



### Cyberpunk 2077 delayed... again

The most-anticipated title of the year has been delayed, yet again, to 10 December 2020. <http://digit.in/nov20-85>



### Saving the planet

Dendra Systems is using video-drones and AI to reseed forests, and speed up reforestation. <http://digit.in/nov20-86>

the wireless devices were all seeing one out of every three or four packets getting dropped. This was enormously frustrating since everything that you did on your phone would be jittery. Websites would stop loading momentarily and then restart, videos would barely buffer since a lot of packets were getting dropped.

With frustration having hit peak limit, I pulled out my screwdriver and

opened the damn router and right off the bat anyone could sense the problem. The SoC was ridiculously hot to the touch. I don't know what kind of QA the company was running but no SoC should be scalding hot. I switched the device off and pulled out one of the aluminium heat sink blocks I'd gotten for my Raspberry Pi. After installing the heatsink with a generous dollop of thermal paste between the SoC and

the heatsink, temperatures went down to much more manageable levels. And my network woes finally went away. A quick email to the manufacturer regarding the issue was met with a note of thanks but I don't know if the manufacturer will incorporate the change. All I can say is that I'm finally going to enjoy some Wi-Fi 6 network goodness, and hopefully, the experience is much better this time around. **4**

## BUYING ADVICE

### GAMING LAPTOP FOR 120K

**Q** Dear Agent001, I am a 13 year old student. I am looking forward to buying a laptop after around 6 months (So you can recommend upcoming laptops) and my budget is ₹120K. I am mostly going to use it for programming (Visual Studio), creating games (Unreal Engine & Unity), video editing (DaVinci Resolve) & playing AAA games (Apex Legends, Rainbow Six Siege, CSGO). I prefer to go with an Intel processor. Also, I need a webcam because of online classes. It should weigh less than 2.5kg with good thermals. I also prefer a 15.6-inch screen. I am considering the Hp Omen 15 2020, Lenovo 5i & Asus Rog Strix G17. Also recommend a good mouse under ₹2K. Thank you.

—Anvith Hegde

**A** Hey Anvith, You seem to have zeroed in on some pretty good models already. If you're buying laptops during normal periods then the most you're going to get would be a laptop with GTX 1660 Ti along with an 10th Gen Intel Core



MSI GF65 Thin

i7 processor. During sale periods, you might be able to get a laptop with an RTX 2060 graphics card. Those tend to sell for 135–150K during normal periods. Most laptops should come with a high refresh rate panel. The recent releases tend to have 240 Hz panels and are more expensive, the older models would have 120 Hz panels and cost less than a lakh. Ideally, you'd want the newer model since the older ones will not have full warranties once they're closing in on their EOL date. I'd also recommend that you check out the latest ROG Strix Scar and the MSI GF65 Thin since they also fit your requirements very well.

Coming to your mouse, you can go with the Logitech G402 Hyperion Fury for around ₹2.3K. The sensor is really good and the mouse has five additional buttons. More importantly, the mouse sensor is excellent in that price range.

### GOOGLE MEETS ON RASPBERRY PI

**Q** Hey Agent001, I've got many Google Meet calls for my online school classes and there is a problem with my setup. I use a Raspberry Pi 2 (the problem is not in the Raspberry Pi). When I am asked a question in the meeting I can't talk and when I enable the microphone (CTRL-D), it doesn't work. When I switch off the camera, (CTRL-E), the camera turns off. So I realised the problem is not in the keyboard. So please suggest a good quality microphone below ₹600. (Google Meet says when I use different devices, a device for the microphone and another device for speakers it can cause echo, so please look into it.)

—Vikram P

**A** Hey Vikram, The Raspberry Pi does not have a native audio input capability so you need to use a USB microphone. Your Raspberry Pi is seeing your audio output and audio input being managed by two separate hardware drivers which is why the whole problem of feedback happens. To fix that, you should either use a USB headset which has both the



Quantum QHM-23

microphone and the earphones. Since you already have a pair of headphones, I'm assuming that you don't want to spend more money that way. In which case, you should look for a USB sound card. That will go into the USB port on the Raspberry Pi and because it's a single device, it will be easy for software such as Google Meets to control the audio input and output to avoid feedback of any sort. There are hundreds of USB sound cards available starting for as low as ₹200 for the Quantum QHM-623. Then, get a splitter cable for your headset so that your microphone and headset signals are channels via different connectors. Hopefully, this should solve your problem. If you don't have a microphone on your headset and want a dedicated microphone for cheap, check out the Maono AU-400. It costs about ₹300. **4**